MODULE 30 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

The Revision Gap

Everything the DOP-C02 exam guide describes that has since been retired, renamed or overtaken, with dates, and how to answer when the guide and today disagree.

DOMAIN All six EXAM WEIGHT 100% MODULE 30 of 34

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The guide describes AWS as it **was**. Answer in the **guide's** terms, and know the **reality** for your job.

Retired or closed: build, deploy and configure

IN THE EXAM GUIDE	WHAT HAPPENED	DATE
AWS OpsWorks, all editions	End of life; Systems Manager replaces it	March to May 2024
AWS CodeStar	Discontinued	31 July 2024
AWS Copilot CLI	End of support	12 June 2026
AWS Proton	End of support	7 October 2026
AWS App Runner	Closed to new customers; ECS Express Mode	30 April 2026
CodeGuru Reviewer and Security	Closed; Security discontinued	November 2025

ON THE EXAM

Chef cookbooks run through State Manager now. Code review moved to Inspector code security and Q Developer.

Retired or closed: monitor, respond and secure

SERVICE OR FEATURE	WHAT HAPPENED	DATE
Systems Manager Incident Manager	Closed to new customers	7 November 2025
Systems Manager Change Manager	Closed to new customers	7 November 2025
CloudWatch Evidently	Discontinued; AppConfig covers flags	17 October 2025
X-Ray SDKs and daemon	Maintenance; end of support February 2027	25 February 2026
Amazon Inspector Classic	End of support	20 May 2026
ARC readiness check	Closed to new customers	30 April 2026

ON THE EXAM

CloudTrail Lake is also no longer open to new customers. Query trails in S3 with Athena instead.

Renamed, split or reversed

OLDER NAME OR STATUS	TODAY
Kinesis Data Firehose	Amazon Data Firehose
Fault Injection Simulator	Fault Injection Service
CodeStar Connections	CodeConnections (provider type still says CodeStarSourceConnection)
AWS Chatbot	Amazon Q Developer in chat applications (February 2025)
Security Hub	Security Hub CSPM, plus a new correlating Security Hub (December 2025)
CodeCommit closed to new customers	Reopened to general availability, 24 November 2025

ON THE EXAM

A renamed service in an exam option is still the same service. Do not reject it for its old name.

New since the guide: pipelines and builds

FEATURE	DATE	MODULE
CodePipeline V2 execution modes: QUEUED, PARALLEL	February 2024	2
Stage conditions; CodeBuild and Commands rules	2024; March 2025	2
Manual approval timeout configurable, 5 minutes to 60 days	2024	2
CodeBuild Lambda compute and reserved capacity fleets	2023 to 2024	3
Inspector code security for repositories	June 2025	4
CodePipeline Lambda deploy action with canary and linear	May 2025	7

ON THE EXAM

Many 'least overhead' answers moved from Lambda glue to these built-in features.

New since the guide: images and deployments

FEATURE	DATE	MODULE
ECR-to-ECR pull through cache	March 2025	5
ECR tag immutability exclusion patterns	July 2025	5
ECR managed signing; archive storage class	November 2025	5
CodeDeploy zonal configuration; termination hooks	2024	6
ECS native blue/green	July 2025	7
ECS native linear and canary	October 2025	7

ON THE EXAM

CodeDeploy blue/green for ECS is still valid. ECS-native is now AWS's recommendation for new services.

New since the guide: infrastructure as code

FEATURE	DATE	MODULE
CloudFormation IaC generator	February 2024	9
Custom resource ServiceTimeout	June 2024	9
Hooks with Guard and Lambda; managed proactive controls	November 2024; September 2025	10
Stack refactoring	February 2025	9
Drift-aware change sets	November 2025	9
CDK refactor command, preview	September 2025	11

ON THE EXAM

Drift-aware change sets and stack refactoring replace several older multi-step workarounds.

New since the guide: organisations and fleets

FEATURE	DATE	MODULE
Resource control policies	November 2024	12
Centralised root access management	November 2024	24
Declarative policies	December 2024	12
Systems Manager just-in-time node access	April 2025	13
SCPs support the full IAM policy language	19 September 2025	12
Control Tower landing zone 4.0; controls-only option	November 2025	12

ON THE EXAM

Older material saying SCP Allow statements cannot use conditions is now wrong.

New since the guide: resilience

FEATURE	DATE	MODULE
Attached EBS status checks; Auto Scaling EBS health checks	August 2024	20
Aurora Serverless v2 scales to zero	November 2024	15
EKS Auto Mode	December 2024	15
Backup multi-party approval for air-gapped vaults	June 2025	16
DynamoDB global tables with strong consistency	June 2025	14
ARC Region switch	August 2025	14

ON THE EXAM

Zero-RPO multi-Region data is now possible with DynamoDB, but only across exactly three Regions.

New since the guide: observability and events

FEATURE	DATE	MODULE
X-Ray OpenTelemetry endpoint and Transaction Search	November 2024	19
Logs Insights SQL and PPL	December 2024	18
EventBridge direct cross-account targets	January 2025	21
CloudWatch investigations generally available	June 2025	22
CloudWatch Logs centralisation across accounts and Regions	September 2025	17
AWS DevOps Agent generally available	April 2026	22

ON THE EXAM

New tracing work should use OpenTelemetry. Existing X-Ray SDK answers still reflect the guide.

New since the guide: security

FEATURE	DATE	MODULE
IAM Access Analyzer custom policy checks, incl. no public access	2023; July 2024	24
CloudFront VPC origins	November 2024	26
VPC Block Public Access	November 2024	26
GuardDuty Extended Threat Detection	December 2024	27
ACM exportable public certificates	June 2025	25
ACM public certificates limited to 198 days	February 2026	25

ON THE EXAM

CloudFront VPC origins replace the secret-header pattern for load balancer origins.

Answering when the guide and today disagree

- If the only option that fits is a retired service, choose it: the exam still marks it right.
- If a newer native feature fits every requirement, it is likely the intended answer.
- Treat renamed services as the same service under either name.
- Never talk yourself out of a correct guide-era answer because it is no longer fashionable.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The exam rewards the design that meets every stated requirement, not the newest one.

What has not changed

- IAM evaluation: explicit deny wins; both sides must allow across accounts.
- CodeDeploy lifecycle hooks on EC2, and the previous-revision ApplicationStop rule.
- CloudFormation fundamentals: change sets, policies, cfn-init, cfn-signal, cfn-hup.
- Auto Scaling policies, lifecycle hooks, and the release loop from module 1.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The foundations the exam tests most are stable. The drift sits mostly at the edges.

Module 30 in five lines

- Answer in the guide's terms; know the reality for your job.
- Retired: OpsWorks, CodeStar, Copilot, Proton, CodeGuru, Evidently, Inspector Classic.
- Renamed: Data Firehose, CodeConnections, Q Developer in chat, Security Hub CSPM.
- New: native ECS deployments, stage conditions, drift-aware change sets, RCPs, and more.
- The foundations are stable. The drift is at the edges.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Next, modules 31 to 34: four practice papers, 20 questions each, weighted like the real exam.